

GRADUATE COURSE SYLLABUS

NEUR 740: Neuropsychological Assessment & Cognitive Rehabilitation

Department of Clinical Neurosciences & Cognitive Psychology • Fall Term 2026

PRIMARY FACULTY

Dr. Elena Vance, Ph.D., ABPP-CN
evance@neuroclinic.edu

ACADEMIC STRUCTURE

Credits: 4.0
Grading: Decimal (0.0 – 4.0) Scale

CLINICAL CONSULTATION

Wednesdays 1:00 PM – 3:30 PM PST
Neuropsychology Lab 402 & Telehealth

COURSE CATALOG DESCRIPTION

This doctoral-level practicum examines the administration, psychometric interpretation, and clinical reporting of standardized neuropsychological test batteries across adult and geriatric clinical cohorts. Emphasis is placed on traumatic brain injury (TBI), cerebrovascular accidents, executive dysfunction, neurodegenerative diseases, and performance validity testing (PVT). Students formulate tailored neurocognitive rehabilitation plans, participate in live psychometric administration labs, and learn multidisciplinary consultation.

PROGRAM COMPETENCIES & PROFESSIONAL BENCHMARKS

- **Competency 1 (Psychometric Mastery):** Standardized administration and scoring of core cognitive batteries (WAIS-IV, WMS-IV, D-KEFS, Wisconsin Card Sorting Test).
- **Competency 2 (Differential Diagnosis):** Integrate clinical interview history, neuroimaging findings, and psychometric scores into differential neurocognitive diagnoses.
- **Competency 3 (Validity & Malingering):** Administer, score, and ethically interpret symptom validity (SVT) and performance validity tests (PVT) in forensic and medical contexts.
- **Competency 4 (Rehabilitation Design):** Create evidence-based cognitive compensatory interventions and environmental modifications for patients and interdisciplinary care teams.

COURSE ASSIGNMENTS & WEIGHT DISTRIBUTION

ASSIGNMENT DESCRIPTION	WEIGHT	DUE MODULE	DELIVERABLE FORMAT
Comprehensive Neuropsychological Battery Report	35%	Module 06	10–12 Page Full Diagnostic Report & Table
Simulated Standardized Battery Administration	25%	Module 08	60-Minute Live Practical Exam in Testing Lab
Cognitive Rehabilitation Protocol Design	20%	Module 10	8-Page Compensatory Strategy Blueprint
Case Conference Seminar & Grand Rounds	20%	Continuous	Weekly Case Contributions & Diagnostic Briefs
Total Course Grade	100%	Term End	

ASSIGNMENT DESCRIPTION	WEIGHT	DUE MODULE	DELIVERABLE FORMAT
			Cumulative Decimal Grade Point Average

ASSIGNMENT SPECIFICATIONS

1. Comprehensive Neuropsychological Battery Report (35%)

Students receive raw psychometric test protocols and neuroimaging data for a de-identified complex patient presenting with cognitive complaints. Students must score all subtests, convert scores to standardized norms (T-scores, z-scores, percentiles), construct an integrated psychometric summary table, analyze strengths and deficits, and deliver a formal 10–12 page diagnostic report adhering to APA division 40 guidelines.

2. Simulated Standardized Battery Administration (25%)

Conducted in the Neuropsychology Assessment Lab. Each student executes a timed, standardized administration of selected subtests from the WAIS-IV and D-KEFS with a standardized patient actor. Evaluators assess basal/ceiling precision, verbatim prompting fidelity, and behavioral observation recording.

3. Cognitive Rehabilitation Protocol Design (20%)

Students design an individual evidence-based cognitive intervention program addressing severe executive dysfunction, attentional lapses, or prospective memory deficits following stroke or TBI. The report requires functional restorative exercises, external compensatory aids (smart prompts, memory logs), and caregiver communication guidelines.

4. Case Conference Seminar & Grand Rounds (20%)

Assessed through active participation during weekly case conference rounds. Students submit a 1-page diagnostic differential brief for weekly patient profiles and present one formal case during Module 11 grand rounds.

WEEKLY TERM SCHEDULE & READING REQUIREMENTS

TIMELINE	MODULE	CORE CLINICAL TOPIC	ASSIGNED READINGS
Week 01	Module 01	Neuroanatomy, Functional Localization & Interviewing	Lezak et al. (Ch. 1–3); Luria (Ch. 2)
Week 02	Module 02	Intellectual Assessment & Working Memory (WAIS-IV)	Groth-Marnat (Ch. 4 & 5); Lichtenberger (Ch. 2)
Week 03	Module 03	Memory Systems, Amnesias & WMS-IV Interpretation	Lezak et al. (Ch. 11 & 12); Squire (Ch. 3)
Week 04	Module 04	Executive Functioning, Inhibition & D-KEFS Profiling	Delis et al. (Ch. 1–4); Stuss & Benson (Ch. 6)
Week 05	Module 05	Performance Validity Testing (PVT) & Malingering	Slick et al. (Ch. 2); Boone (Ch. 4 & 7)
Week 06	Module 06	Traumatic Brain Injury & Post-Concussive Syndrome	Silver et al. (Ch. 8 & 9); McCrea (Ch. 3)

TIMELINE	MODULE	CORE CLINICAL TOPIC	ASSIGNED READINGS
Week 07	Module 07	Dementia Differentials (AD, FTD, Lewy Body, Vascular)	Cummings & Mega (Ch. 5–7); Petersen (Ch. 4)
Week 08	Module 08	Standardized Administration Lab Exam (Cohort A/B)	Lab Testing Manual & Scoring Protocols
Week 09	Module 09	Cognitive Rehabilitation: Restorative vs Compensatory	Sohlberg & Mateer (Ch. 1–4); Wilson (Ch. 3)
Week 10	Module 10	Assistive Technology & Environmental Restructuring	Sohlberg & Mateer (Ch. 7 & 8); Cicerone et al. (2019)
Week 11	Module 11	Grand Rounds Presentations & Ethics in Reporting	APA Division 40 Ethics Guidelines

Late Submission & Incomplete Policy: Due dates are strictly enforced to simulate clinical hospital deadlines. Late submissions without verified medical documentation incur a 2% deduction per 24 hours up to a maximum of 5 days. Extension requests must be submitted in writing at least 48 hours in advance.

COURSEPAL PARSER & APPLICATION MAPPING GUIDE

This document structure has been optimized for clean automated parsing into your CoursePal architecture. Below are the precise app views and fields populated upon upload:

1. ASSIGNMENTS & GRADES DASHBOARD

- **Diagnostic Battery Report:** Populates as a major written milestone, weight: 35%, due Module 06.
- **Standardized Battery Admin:** Populates as an experiential exam, weight: 25%, scheduled for Module 08.
- **Rehabilitation Protocol:** Populates as a project deliverable, weight: 20%, due Module 10.
- **Case Conference Grand Rounds:** Populates as a continuous participation grade, weight: 20%.

2. WEEKLY READING & RESOURCE TRACKER

- Extracts 11 weekly reading blocks into clickable to-do checkboxes (e.g., *Lezak et al. Ch. 1–3*, *Sohlberg & Mateer Ch. 1–4*).
- Automatically indexes testing manual references and clinical guidelines into the course resource drawer.

3. SMART CALENDAR & REMINDER ALERTS

- Schedules 11 weekly Wednesday lecture and lab events.
- Sets 48-hour automated push reminders prior to major assignment cutoffs based on the syllabus extension window.